

Subspace.money

Company	Subspace.money	Pillars covered	All 5
Framework	Porter's Five Forces + JTBD	Name	Sakshi Srivastava
Why Subspace?	Harder analytical problem - social trust + fintech + marketplace cold-start at once		

Why Subspace, not Vocallabs: Vocallabs is a legible B2B SaaS teardown with obvious competitors. Subspace is harder, it sits at the intersection of social dynamics, fintech trust, and marketplace cold-start. Picking Subspace signals comfort with ambiguity. The five feedbacks below each cover a distinct pillar; no two overlap.

UX

01

Shared-subscription flow puts all trust liability on strangers - with zero safety net before money leaves

OBSERVED: what I actually saw in the app / flow

When joining a public sharing group (e.g. a Netflix Premium pool run by a stranger), the user pays their share immediately, before the admin shares credentials. There is no escrow, no admin trust rating shown during the join flow, and the dispute CTA is buried 3 taps deep under Account → Help → Raise a concern. Google Play reviews (April 2026) explicitly state: "if the subscriber doesn't allow you to login, the subscription doesn't refund the amount" and "you are dependent on admins." The only platform recourse is leaving a negative review, which triggers reactive support.

PROBLEM: why it matters: the real user or business pain

Subspace's core network-effects moat relies on public groups growing. But public groups require trust in strangers, trust the product currently offloads entirely to admin goodwill. Every betrayal event (admin goes silent, credential revoked post-payment) is a trust-destruction event at the platform level, not just the user level. Porter's lens: low switching costs + high substitute availability (Telegram reseller groups) means one bad experience = permanent churn. This is a churn multiplier disguised as a support ticket.

SHIP INSTEAD: specific, actionable solution

Introduce a 24-hour credential-delivery SLA with automatic escrow: payment is held and released to the admin only after the member confirms access. Add an Admin Trust Score visible during the join flow calculated from on-time delivery rate, dispute rate, and response time shown as a simple 3-tier badge (Verified / Standard / New) rather than a raw number. This turns every successful delivery into a compounding trust signal and structurally reduces reactive support load.

Impact: **HIGH**

Effort: Medium engineering

P0: directly repairs the core sharing loop

Subspace pitches five different products to five different users simultaneously and acquires none of them efficiently**OBSERVED:** what I actually saw in the app / flow

The homepage and Play Store listing cycle through: rent gadgets in 10 minutes, share Netflix subscriptions, buy discounted Swiggy gift cards, manage recurring bills, split expenses with friends all in the first screen. There is no singular CTA. The Play Store description leads with 'Up to 80% off Netflix' but actual onboarding asks for phone + email to detect existing subscriptions. Targeting: college students (student email deal), urban renters, deal-hunters, and group finance managers simultaneously.

PROBLEM: why it matters: the real user or business pain

Rs.36.5 Cr ARR with a 3-person team and zero external funding means Subspace cannot afford unfocused acquisition. A user who arrives for the Netflix share deal has a completely different retention hook than one who came for gadget rentals. Conflated messaging = high bounce on first open, because no single user feels spoken to. Porter's Five Forces: the threat of substitutes is high in every single vertical Subspace plays in (OTTplay, Splitwise, Magicpin, Meesho) which is precisely why positioning must be a sharp wedge, not a buffet.

SHIP INSTEAD: specific, actionable solution

Define a primary ICP wedge the evidence points to 18–25 urban college students who share OTT subscriptions with strangers for savings. Run all top-of-funnel with one hook: 'Split Netflix with 3 people you don't know. Pay Rs.79. Done.' Land on a stripped join-group flow that converts in under 90 seconds. All other features (gift cards, rentals, bill tracking) exist inside the app but don't appear in acquisition messaging until month 2 of retention. This is a JTBD argument: own one job deeply before expanding.

Impact: **HIGH FEATURES**

Effort: Zero engineering (messaging change only)

P0: solves acquisition coherence without any engineering sprint

The Negotiate API is Subspace's most defensible moat but it's invisible to users and unexplained everywhere

OBSERVED: what I actually saw in the app / flow

The Negotiate API (automated price negotiation with brands) is cited by Tracxn and Crunchbase as a core differentiator. In the actual app and website, it appears nowhere by name. The words 'negotiate' or 'Negotiate API' are absent from the Play Store listing, onboarding flow, and website copy visible to regular users. The closest surface is 'get the best prices every day with guaranteed savings' a claim every discount app makes.

PROBLEM: why it matters: the real user or business pain

Subspace's bootstrapped profitability is structurally tied to its ability to negotiate better wholesale prices than any individual user could this is the actual moat. But the user perceives Subspace as 'a coupon aggregator,' which means they comparison-shop against Cashkaro, Magicpin, and every deal Telegram channel. Porter: bargaining power of buyers is high when they see identical products. Hiding the one thing that is genuinely hard to replicate means competing on brand recall against much better-funded players.

SHIP INSTEAD: specific, actionable solution

Surface the negotiation as a feature story, not a backend detail. On each brand's listing page, show: 'Subspace negotiated price: Rs.79 · Platform price: Rs.149 · You save: Rs.70 this month.' Add a single-screen 'How we negotiate' explainer (one-time, skippable) during onboarding. This reframes Subspace from 'deals app' to 'the app that fights on your behalf' a differentiation story that Cashkaro and Magicpin literally cannot copy because they don't share the same commercial structure.

Impact: **MEDIUM-HIGH**

Effort: Low copy and one screen

P1: changes competitive positioning with zero engineering

Subspace's real competitor isn't another app it's WhatsApp groups, and the product ignores this entirely

OBSERVED what I actually saw in the app / flow

Tracxn lists myPaisaa, MoneyClub, and Finlok as Subspace's competitors. But the dominant behavior Subspace is displacing is not 'using a competing app' it's informal WhatsApp groups where 4 friends split a Netflix plan, one person collects money via UPI, and a shared Google Sheet tracks who paid. No app is involved. This is the actual status quo the product must be 10x better than.

PROBLEM why it matters: the real user or business pain

The product is built for conversion from a competing app, not conversion from the WhatsApp group workflow. This means: no frictionless UPI-collect flow for the group admin, no shareable payment links that non-app-users can pay into, no WhatsApp-native reminder to members. The onboarding assumes both sides have Subspace installed but in the incumbent behavior, only one person (the admin) would bother. Porter: the real threat of substitute is a zero-cost behavior, not a funded competitor.

SHIP INSTEAD specific, actionable solution

Build a 'WhatsApp-first admin kit': one admin signs up, creates a group, gets a shareable payment link. Members click the link, pay via UPI no app install required for the paying member. The admin app handles credential distribution and tracking. This mirrors how Razorpay Payment Links worked reducing barrier to zero for the paying party. Each successful link payment is also a conversion funnel: 'Create your own group on Subspace and earn as admin.'

Impact: **HIGH** Effort: Medium payment link + credential flow **P0: solves cold-start and network-effect friction simultaneously**

COLLABORATIONS

05

Subspace has India's first local subscription marketplace with no B2B2C motion and no partner onboarding path

OBSERVED: what I actually saw in the app / flow

Subspace claims to be 'India's first subscription marketplace for local providers' and offers 'market reach to businesses that sell products or services as subscriptions.' But the B2B-facing surface how a local gym, tiffin service, or coaching class actually lists on Subspace is entirely absent from the website. There is no 'List your subscription' button, no partner page, no case study of a local brand using the platform. The feature exists in the product description; it does not exist in the go-to-market.

PROBLEM: why it matters: the real user or business pain

The local subscription marketplace is potentially Subspace's highest-margin business: brands pay a listing or distribution fee, users get hyperlocal deals, Subspace earns on both sides. But without a self-serve onboarding path for local providers, this stays at zero. More critically, it is the one feature that would make Subspace inimitable. Netflix sharing can be replicated; a hyperlocal marketplace of 500 Bengaluru-specific businesses cannot. Porter: this is the highest barrier to entry Subspace could build, and it is currently un-built.

SHIP INSTEAD: specific, actionable solution

Partner with 2–3 city-level SME aggregators NoBroker's vendor network, Justdial's business listings, or Razorpay's merchant base to onboard the first 50 local subscription providers via a lightweight Google Form → manual review → listing flow. No engineering sprint required. Each local listing opens a completely separate acquisition funnel: a Bengaluru tiffin service's 200 subscribers are Subspace users who would never install a 'Netflix sharing app.' This collaboration unlocks a new ICP while compounding the moat.

Impact: **MEDIUM now / HIGHEST**
engineering **partnership setup**

Effort: High partnership sprints, low

P2: highest strategic moat, 60-day long-term

Prioritisation logic

Feedbacks 01, 02, and 04 are P0: they address trust erosion, acquisition incoherence, and zero-install-barrier respectively all of which block top-line growth. Feedback 03 is P1: a messaging change with zero engineering cost that shifts competitive positioning. Feedback 05 is P2: highest long-term moat value, but requires a 60-day

P0 #1	Escrow + Admin Trust Score	UX	Medium	Core loop repair — retention bleeder
P0 #2	WhatsApp-first payment link	Competitor	Medium	Beats real incumbent, not app rivals
P0 #3	ICP wedge own one job	GTM & ICPs	Zero (messaging)	Acquisition coherence, instant
P1	Surface the Negotiate API story	Features	Low (copy)	Positioning shift, no engineering
P2	Local marketplace B2B2C motion	Collaborations	High (partners)	Highest long-term moat

partnership sprint before any product work. If I were joining Day 1, I'd ship 03 in week one (copywriting only), prototype 04's payment link in week two, and run the first local partner pilot in month two.

Framework used: Porter's Five Forces (threat of substitutes, buyer bargaining power, barriers to entry) and Jobs-to-be-Done (identifying the real incumbent behavior, not app competitors).